

The Use of Technology in Education

Introduction

With the increase in technological advances, especially in the recent years, technology is already transforming education globally, and Singapore is no exception.

For example, platforms like SLS and Google classroom are starting to be used more and more.

HOWEVER, there are still a multitude of issues surrounding this.

Issues around using technology for education

Accessability

Despite what you may think, Singapore, like many places around the world, has a digital divide, where many households , usually those in poverty, are unable to access technology.

However, the government and some non profits have put in effort to get these children access to laptops.



IMDA

<https://www.imda.gov.sg> > How We Can Help

DigitalAccess@Home

DigitalAccess@Home provides subsidised broadband and laptops/tablets to lower-income households to support their lifestyle needs, including work and social ...

Effectiveness

Although technology has many benefits, like ease of access to a lot of information, and AI chatbots being able to help with studies, it is also harmful when not used properly.

Technology in education can be a big distraction to students, and an over-reliance on technology, which can cause major problems.

While the government have tried to battle the distraction part, it has caused other problems too.

Privacy Concerns

With technology comes big risks, including data breaches, hacks, and more.

Additionally, with the rise of AI, both learning tools (like SLS) and students are beginning to use AI chatbots more and more in their education.

This can introduce issues like AI bias, and makes privacy a concern for the government.

Singapore

'How am I going to pass my O-Levels': Students lose notes due to Mobile Guardian hack

"We didn't even know that this was going to happen, so it just caught us all off guard," said one Secondary 4 student who discovered her notes were gone just as she sat down to revise.

How stakeholders are affected

Students

Students benefit greatly, being able to access a lot of information quickly and easily. However, they may face challenges like increased screen time and distractions, which may negatively impact their education as a whole.

The use of AI can also introduce an over-reliance on AI, causing the students to lack the skill of critical thinking or creativity.

Teachers

Teachers get many benefits too, like the ability to instantly assign or access homework online, and the access to interactive teaching aids.

However, balancing between traditional teaching and learning methods, and using technology is a big challenge. Existing teachers may also need to undergo training to keep up to date.

Solutions

Students

For students, it is mostly up to themselves to manage their use of technology, but there are ways for teachers and parents to help support them.

For example, they should be taught from as early as possible the correct and ethical uses of technology in their education. This can ingrain responsible use of technology in them from a young age, reducing the risk of abuse of tech.

Teachers

Increasing access to technology literacy courses in NIE and SkillsFuture can help teachers to learn more about and understand fair and responsible use of technology.

They can also use tools like GPTZero to ensure that students do not use AI to do their schoolwork.

Conclusion

Technology is a powerful collection of tools, but it needs careful and thoughtful integration into the system to prevent major problems from emerging.

